The Build Financial Wellness™ Zero-Based Budgeting Tool

A zero-based budgeting plan gives every dollar a purpose before the month begins. When projected income minus your plan equals zero, your income is fully assigned to expenses, savings, and goals.

Your Plan At-A-Glance

Use this summary to track your progress as you build your plan. Total Planned reflects the amount assigned across all categories, and Difference shows the amount that remains unassigned. When difference reaches $0.00, every dollar of your projected income has a purpose.

PROJECTED INCOME	Enter total expected net (after tax, take home) income for the month.	
TOTAL PLANNED	Total assigned across all expense and savings categories.	**$ 0.00**
DIFFERENCE	Projected income minus total planned. Aim for zero.	**$ 0.00**

1 Build Your Monthly Plan

Enter the amounts you plan to assign to housing, household utilities, and related home expenses this month.

Home & Utilities	Planned Amount
Mortgage or rent	
HOA or community fees	
Electricity	
Gas	
Water and sewer	
Trash	
Phone	
Internet	
Homeowners or renters' insurance not included in mortgage or rent payment	
Other:	
Other:	
Other:	
Home & Utilities Total	**$ 0.00**

Start with what you know today. Adjust amounts as your plan becomes clearer.

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2 Plan for Regular Commitments

Include savings goals and payments you expect to make this month.

Savings & Future Goals	Planned Amount
Emergency Savings	
General savings	
Retirement contributions outside payroll	
Investment contributions	
Health Savings Account contributions outside payroll	
Education or college savings	
Sinking funds	
Other:	
Other:	
Other:	
Savings & Future Goals Total	**$ 0.00**

Debt & Required Payments	Planned Amount
Vehicle loan	
Student loan	
Personal loan	
Credit card	
Medical payment	
Child support or alimony	
Other:	
Other:	
Other:	
Debt & Required Payments Total	**$ 0.00**

Make savings and additional debt payments part of the plan, not what is left over.

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3 Plan for Everyday Expenses

Use realistic amounts based on what you usually spend.

Food & Household	Planned Amount
Groceries	
Restaurants or takeout	
Household supplies	
Home maintenance	
Other:	
Other:	
Other:	
Food & Household Total	**$ 0.00**

Transportation, Personal & Family	Planned Amount
Fuel	
Bus or ride share fares	
Auto insurance	
Childcare	
School expenses	
Medical care or prescriptions	
Health insurance not deducted from pay	
Life insurance not deducted from pay	
Personal care	
Clothing	
Entertainment or recreation	
Cable or streaming services	
Other:	
Other:	
Other:	
Transportation, Personal & Family Total	**$ 0.00**

A workable plan reflects your actual responsibilities, not a perfect month.

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4 Look Beyond the Month

Set aside a monthly amount for expenses that arrive occasionally, seasonally, or once a year

Pet Care	Planned Amount
Food	
Medical care or prescriptions	
Grooming	
Boarding or sitting	
Walking	
Other:	
Other:	
Other:	
Pet Care Total	**$ 0.00**

Seasonal, Annual, & Irregular Expenses	Planned Amount
Vehicle registration	
Vehicle repairs or maintenance	
Insurance paid less than monthly	
Home repairs or maintenance	
School or extracurricular expenses	
Holidays, celebrations, or gifts	
Travel or vacations	
Membership fees	
Annual subscriptions	
Professional fees	
Taxes not deducted from pay or included in other payments	
Medical, dental, or vision costs	
Charities or donations	
Legal fees	
Other:	
Other:	
Other:	
Seasonal, Annual, & Irregular Expenses Total	**$ 0.00**

Your difference doesn't have to reach zero on the first draft.

Review, adjust, and keep assigning until every dollar has a purpose.

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